

What a friend we have in Jesus

Text: Joseph M. Scriven, 1855, alt.

Music: Charles C. Converse, 1868

CONVERSE 87.87 D

The musical score is written for a four-part setting (Soprano, Alto, Tenor, Bass) in 4/4 time, with a key signature of two flats (B-flat and E-flat). The melody is primarily in the Soprano and Alto parts, with the Tenor and Bass parts providing harmonic support. The lyrics are arranged in three systems, each with three lines of text. The first system covers the first line of the hymn, the second system covers the second and third lines, and the third system covers the fourth and fifth lines. The score includes various musical notations such as notes, rests, and bar lines. Chord symbols (E-flat, A-flat, B-flat, B-flat7) are placed above the staff to indicate the harmonic structure. The lyrics are printed below the staff, with line numbers 1, 2, and 3 indicating the different parts of the hymn.

1 What a friend we have in Je - sus, all our sins and griefs to bear!
2 Have we tri - als and temp - ta - tions? Is there trou - ble an - y - where?
3 Are we weak and heav - y la - den, 'cum - bered with a load of care?

What a priv - i - lege to car - ry ev - 'ry - thing to God in prayer!
We should nev - er be dis - cour - aged - take it to the Lord in prayer!
Pre - cious Sav - ior, still our ref - uge, take it to the Lord in prayer!

Oh, what peace we of - ten for - feit, oh, what need - less pain we bear,
Can we find a friend so faith - ful, who will all our sor - rows share?
Do thy friends de - spise, for - sake thee? Take it to the Lord in prayer!

all be - cause we do not car - ry ev - 'ry - thing to God in prayer!
Je - sus knows our ev - 'ry weak - ness - take it to the Lord in prayer!
Je - sus' arms will take and shield thee - thou wilt find a sol - ace there.